

# Bio 152 | Spring 2025

## Independent Project Final Paper Student Reflection

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**Name:**

**Project collaborators (if applicable):**

Congratulations on completing your final paper for the Independent Project! You've done so much work on this project throughout the semester, and you should celebrate all you've accomplished. In thinking about your final paper and your IP experience, please address the prompts below. As in the self-evaluations you completed for the first and second drafts, the specific responses you provide will not have any negative impact on your grade on the final paper. Therefore, an honest evaluation of your work and thoughtful reflection on what you've learned is going to be the most beneficial.

*Address the questions below to the best of your ability. Add space as needed below each question.*

1. If you had to grade your final paper on a scale of 1 to 5, how would you score it? Use the criteria below.

SCORE:   4  

- Poor (1): This paper has fundamental flaws. It might be hard to understand, be completely off topic, or be missing essential components. While some of the required elements might be present in the draft, none of them were successful.
- Fair (2): This submission has some substantial issues. There might be the beginnings of good elements, but they are far from complete or clear.
- Good (3): This submission is on the right track but might be lacking detail and/or content depth. It might take some effort to understand the study and biological rationales for the project.
- Very good (4): The paper is successful in conveying information clearly and there is logical flow throughout the paper. There are still some small improvements to be made, but it is in very good shape at this stage.
- Excellent (5): All the elements are executed extremely well. The content is easy to understand, and its importance is clear. Any suggested changes are purely a matter of reader preference and don't impact clarity.

2. What are your greatest strengths as a writer and researcher? How well do you think your final paper demonstrates those strengths?

My greatest strength would be making statistical analysis and creating figures around it. I think the paper has good statistical tests and the tables/figures are clear and informative.

3. What parts of the IP are you proudest of? Are there parts of the paper, poster, or project more broadly about which you feel unsure or lack confidence?

I think the paper turned out well. Originally, when I heard we had to write a paper I wanted to do it alone so I could write about computer-architecture registers algorithms. However, when we got partners, I knew it would benefit my freshman partner far more to choose a subject he's wants to learn about so I let him choose. Although I didn't know too much government benefits and education rates of general populations, I think I did a decent job putting my skills to use on it.

4. Describe your writing and editing process for the IP paper. Are there parts of that process that you plan to change for future writing and/or research assignments?  
I write a ton of gibberish and slowly cut it down every week. No.
5. What were the most useful comments you received regarding the IP during the semester?  
I think pretty much all were useful. Nothing was particularly notable as all comments were great.
6. What do you know now (about yourself, the project, the content, teamwork, etc.) that you wish you had known at the beginning of the semester?  
Nothing.
7. What was the most challenging aspect of the entire IP?  
I had to constantly keep in mind that I was writing for a younger and more biologically educated audience. I don't think I did a great job in this regard as that was the only complaint in our peer review, but I tried to adjust as I went.
8. What was the most rewarding part of the IP experience?  
Getting the second draft review back then finishing 99% the paper and going to Kollege Klub to celebrate.